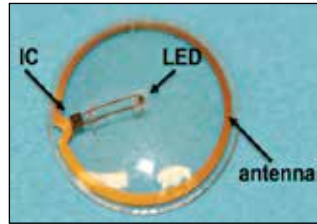


Contact Lenses

As strange as it might sound, contact lenses are already in development which would cover the eye with hundreds of LEDs to augment reality for you. These contact lenses are essentially tiny displays which can be controlled by the built-in circuitry. As technology progresses that tiny amount of real estate will even have integrated systems for



Contact lenses capable of doing AR are going to be available in the future

wireless communications. There is still research going on in this area and the technology is only a little way past the drawing board. One of the ongoing researches includes utilizing solar energy to power up all that electronics in the lens.

Handheld displays

If you are a smartphone user, chances are you have already used AR applications. Even if you are not, we believe this is one AR display which is not going to send any shockwaves of awe. Handheld displays are the most common AR displays and a lot of people already have them in the form of smartphones. These displays possess nothing special in the hardware department from the AR viewpoint.

It is the other hardware components of the phone which bring in the specialties. The components which aid AR on these displays mostly consist of a GPS module, accelerometer, digital compass and components used for data and communication.

The disadvantage of handheld displays is that one needs to keep holding the device in front of oneself all the time.

Spatial displays

Technically speaking these displays are not the normal screens found in other devices. Instead the display is done using a projector. The projector projects the augmented view directly on the object of which the augmented view is needed. That being said, these setups (we would call them as 'setups' instead of 'displays' to save you some confusion) are not meant for individual users but for a group of users.

Spatial displays have the advantage that they need not be worn or carried around (well, literally you cannot as they are preset for a given environment